Barrier Breakers 2027 · Judging

How we score, and the sheet you'll use

Every team gets three judges, 60 seconds to pitch, and two minutes of questions. You score three things, 1 to 5 each. Below each question is what a 5 looks like and what a 2 looks like; a 3 or 4 is somewhere in between, a 1 is nothing there. Score before you walk to the next table.

The three questions

1. Do they get the problem?

Who this costs, how much, and why it's stuck that way.

Give a 5 when	They can tell you who pays, roughly what, and why nobody has fixed it. They talked to someone it affects, or found the numbers themselves.
Give a 2 when	It's a statistic read off the poster. They can't say who, specifically, this is for.

2. Would this actually work?

Not "is it clever." Could it run, could it keep running, and does it reach the people from question 1?

Give a 5 when	There's something on the table: a prototype, a draft, a demo. You can see how it would run, who would run it, and what keeps it going. It fits the problem they described.
Give a 2 when	It's an idea with no next step. Or it would help someone, just not the people they said it was for.

3. Could they explain it?

Clear in 60 seconds. Honest under questions.

Give a 5 when	You understood it before the timer went. They answered what you asked, not what they rehearsed, and every team member could speak to it.
Give a 2 when	You're still not sure what it does. Questions got a shrug, or one person did all the talking while the others looked at the floor.

A few things we care about

- The team that built something ugly that works beats the team with the slick deck.
- Ask the quiet team member a question. Everyone on the team should own the project.
- Use the whole scale. If everyone in your section gets 4s, nobody gets picked.
- Score each team before you move on. Don't go back and adjust once you've seen more.
- Your job is your section's tables. Don't compare to what you hear from other judges.

How it adds up

Your three scores add up to a number out of **15** for each team. The other two judges in your section do the same, so every team ends up with a panel total out of **45**. The highest total in your section goes to **Demo Day**. The second highest is the section's **honorable mention**. If two teams tie, the three of you talk for a minute and pick.

Demo Day, after lunch: the five finalists pitch for five minutes with two minutes of questions. Every judge who stays scores all five on the same three questions, including the one from their own section. Highest combined total takes 1st.

Scorecard

Barrier Breakers 2027 · Gallery round · 1 to 5 on each question · the first row is a worked example

Judge _____ Section _____ Date _____

#	Team	Problem	Works?	Explain	Total	One line
14	**Fare Forward** Bus-pass pooling for shift workers	4	3	5	**12**	Knows exactly who it's for. Costs are a guess. Great under questions.

When you're done: hand this to a FinMango volunteer, or read your totals into your phone. Your section's two highest panel totals are the finalist and the honorable mention.